MAGALANG PAMPANGA
RECEIVED
DATE: 9/3/25 TIME: 10:2
BY:
RECORDS UNIT 194

NARRATIVE REPORT ON LUZON INTER-REGIONAL M&E NETWORK FORUM

The Luzon Inter-Regional Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Network Forum, held on August 28, 2025, convened a distinguished assembly of M&E practitioners, government officials, and key stakeholders at the Widus Hotel in Clark, Pampanga. The forum's central objective was to advance the understanding and application of M&E beyond a mere compliance function, positioning it as an indispensable instrument for strategic planning, adaptive governance, and the achievement of sustainable growth. The proceedings were structured to provide a comprehensive overview of M&E principles, frameworks, and practical applications through a series of plenary and breakout sessions.

The morning plenary sessions established the theoretical and institutional foundations of effective M&E. The initial presentation, delivered by Director Aldwin U. Urbina of the Department of Economy, Planning, and Development's (DEPDev) Monitoring and Evaluation Staff, provided a compelling rationale for M&E. Titled "Measuring What Matters," the presentation underscored the dual purpose of M&E: to ensure that projects are implemented correctly ("doing things right") and, more importantly, that the correct projects are being pursued ("doing the right things"). Director Urbina emphasized that a robust M&E system is vital for driving accountability, fostering transparency, and building public trust by ensuring that resources are utilized efficiently to produce tangible results.

Following this, the Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG) showcased its Results-Based M&E (RBME) Framework for Water Supply and Sanitation Projects. The presentation detailed the evolution of the DILG's M&E strategy, highlighting a shift from a focus on physical and financial progress to a more holistic, results-oriented approach. A key innovation presented was the use of citizen engagement in monitoring, allowing the public to provide direct, real-time feedback on project status through a dedicated portal. This initiative was presented as a means to enhance data quality and ensure greater stakeholder participation and ownership.

The final plenary session, "Paving the Way for Better M&E," was led by ARD Dolores J. Molintas of DEPDev. This address directly confronted the common practice of waiting for problems—such as project delays or cost overruns—to manifest before taking action. ARD Molintas advocated for a paradigm shift from a reactive to a proactive M&E system. The proposed "Shared Path Forward" called for the transformation of M&E findings into a powerful engine for strategic planning and adaptive governance, empowering both implementers and policymakers to utilize monitoring data for early problem identification and evidence-based decision-making.

The afternoon breakout sessions provided practical illustrations of the concepts discussed. Adrian Matthew G. Glova's presentation on the impact evaluation of the Casecnan Multipurpose Irrigation and Power Project (CMIPP) served as a profound case study. He elucidated the challenges and lessons learned, particularly emphasizing the critical need for a well-designed evaluation framework that is established prior to project implementation. Mr. Glova also highlighted the necessity for richer, more granular administrative data and stressed the importance of inter-agency collaboration and buy-in for successful evaluations.

A separate breakout session, led by the Philippine Institute for Development Studies (PIDS), delved into the complexities of evaluating the Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps). The PIDS presentation outlined a spectrum of conceptual, methodological, operational, and political challenges inherent in assessing large-scale social interventions. The discussion underscored the imperative for evaluators to maintain scientific rigor and credibility while

PSAU PRESIDENT'S OFFICE
RECEIVED
P.09
9/03
DATE
MAGALANG, PAMPANGA

navigating diverse stakeholder interests. The session concluded with a summation that called for continuous capacity building, early and strategic evaluation planning, and the allocation of sufficient resources to support comprehensive studies.

In summation, the Luzon Inter-Regional M&E Network Forum served as a crucial platform for cultivating a shared understanding of M&E's transformative potential. The forum's proceedings collectively advanced the notion that M&E is not an administrative burden but a strategic tool for fostering a more transparent, accountable, and effective governance system. The central challenge articulated throughout the day was to ensure that all stakeholders, from national agencies to local implementers, collaboratively work to embed a culture of evidence use, thereby guaranteeing better results for the Filipino people.

Very truly yours,

KEVIN AARON M. PERALTA
Project Development Officer III

Noted by:

DR. RAFAEL R. RAFAEL
Director, Office of Planning, Project Development and Monitoring

Approved by:

DR. ANITA G. DAVID
SUC President IV

PSAU PRESIDENT'S OFFICE
RECEIVED
p.o^m
9/03
DATE
MAGALANG, PAMPANGA

Index number:280
Altitude:185.5meter
Philippines
15° 11' 25.347" N, 120° 31' 32.010" E
231° SW
Thursday, 28 August 2025 at 2:54 PM
M&E
LUZON INTER-REGIONAL M&E NETWORK FORUM
"Cultivating a Culture of M&E for Sustainable Growth"

Index number:278
Altitude:185.5meter
Philippines
15° 11' 25.346" N, 120° 31' 32.010" E
229° SW
Thursday, 28 August 2025 at
DILG's RBME FRAMEWORK
FOR Water Supply and Sanitation Projects
Luzon Inter-Regional M&E Network Forum
Office of Project Development Services

Index number:281
Altitude:185.5meter
Philippines
15° 11' 25.347" N, 120° 31' 32.010" E
233° SW
Thursday, 28 August 2025 at 3:31 PM
Our Shared Questions

Index number:277
Altitude:185.2meter
Philippines
15° 11' 25.332" N, 120° 31' 32.005" E
35° SW
Thursday, 28 August 2025 at 10:19 AM
#GrowWithME
LUZON INTER-REGIONAL M&E NETWORK FORUM
"Cultivating a Culture of M&E for Sustainable Growth"

Index number:275
Altitude:184.9meter
Philippines
15° 11' 25.346" N, 120° 31' 32.010" E
234° SW
Thursday, 28 August 2025 at 9:59 AM
Measuring What Matters:
Advancing Monitoring and Evaluation
ALDWIN U. URBINA

Index number:282
Altitude:185.5meter
Philippines
15° 11' 25.347" N, 120° 31' 32.010" E
238° SW
Thursday, 28 August 2025 at 4:08 PM
M&E
#GrowWithME
CLOSING MESSAGE
JOSEPH J. CAPUNO
Undersecretary
Department of Economy,
Planning, and Development